

# Hive Ideation Context for Build LLM

## Objective

Build a hackathon-winning product that deeply leverages Nomba APIs. The product should require Nomba as core infrastructure rather than merely using it as a payment gateway.

## Ideas Explored

We evaluated Lumo (Uber for Energy), AgentOS, BuildNow, HiveMarket and several infrastructure ideas. Lumo was considered highly original but raised logistics concerns (battery ownership, dispatch, charging, availability).

## Why Hive Won

The original HiveMarket resembled Shopify/Selar/Mainstack. The breakthrough was reframing it as 'Hive'—an AI employee living inside WhatsApp rather than a storefront builder. The primary interface is conversational AI, not a dashboard.

## Product Philosophy

Merchants should never need to learn software. Every business action happens by chatting with Hive. The web dashboard is secondary; WhatsApp is the primary UX.

## Core Merchant Commands

Add products, update inventory, generate invoices, create payment links, answer customer questions, send promotions, view revenue, identify inactive customers and manage orders.

## Customer Journey

Customers discover products via WhatsApp, ask questions in natural language, receive recommendations, pay using Nomba payment links and receive automatic confirmations after webhook verification.

## Role of Nomba

Nomba powers payment links, payment collection and webhook-based reconciliation. Future expansion includes virtual accounts, transfers, subscriptions and split settlements. Nomba is the financial engine that enables autonomous business operations.

## Build Priorities

1. WhatsApp-first experience. 2. AI function calling. 3. Nomba integration. 4. Smooth end-to-end demo. 5. Polished UX over breadth of features.

## North Star

Position Hive as 'The First AI Employee for African SMEs' rather than another commerce platform. The key message is that merchants run their business by chatting with an AI employee.